Exercise library

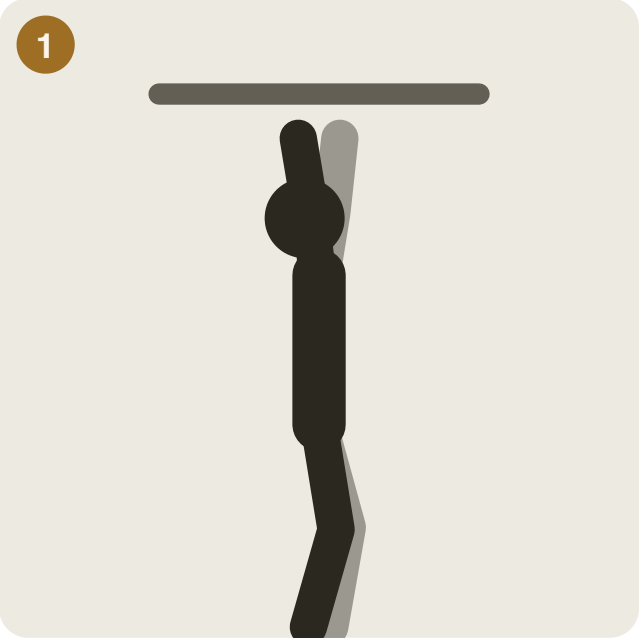
169 exercises, grouped by routine. 52 have illustrations.

Core Circuit

Hanging leg lift

Core · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Hang from the bar, shoulders set, legs straight down
2. Lift the legs to hip height without swinging

Oblique weighted arm dip

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Sit-up to stand-up

Core · Strength · Loads: lower back.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Wheelbarrow

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Oblique knee raise plank

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Farmer walk

Full body · Strength · Loads: fingers, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

A-frame drop

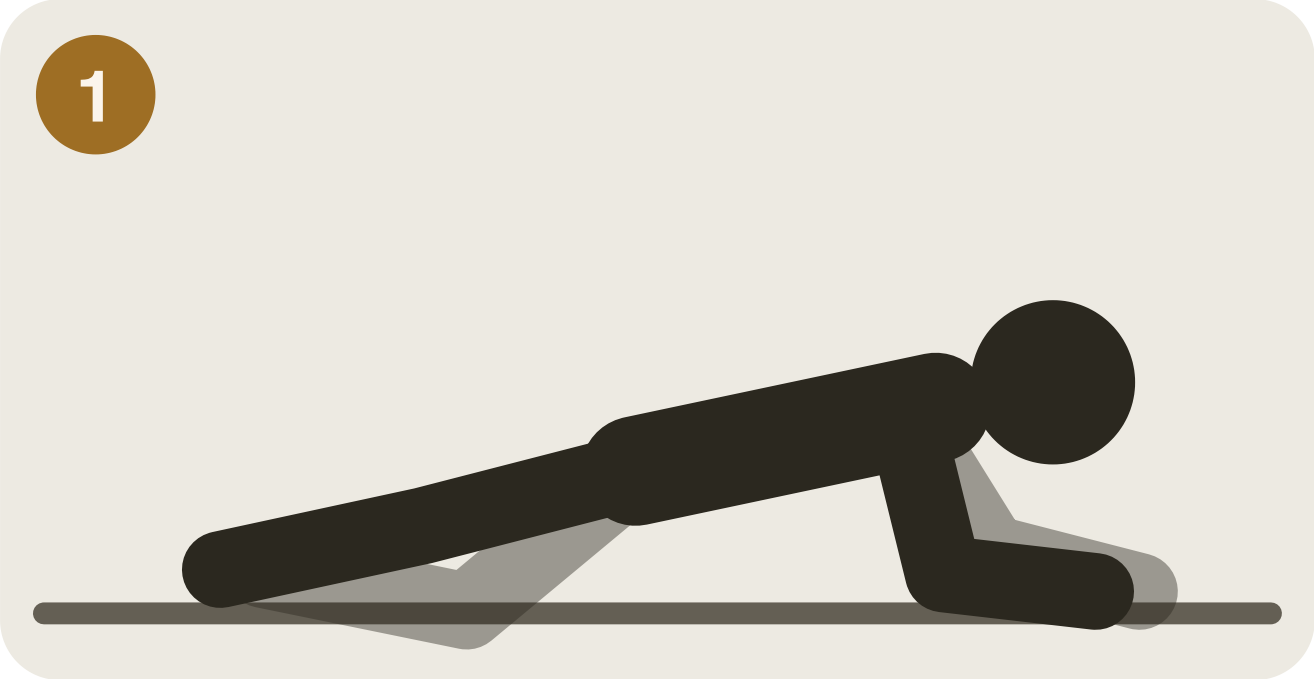
Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, lower back.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Plank (elevated)

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Forearms down, body one straight line from head to heels

Plank (sideways walk)

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

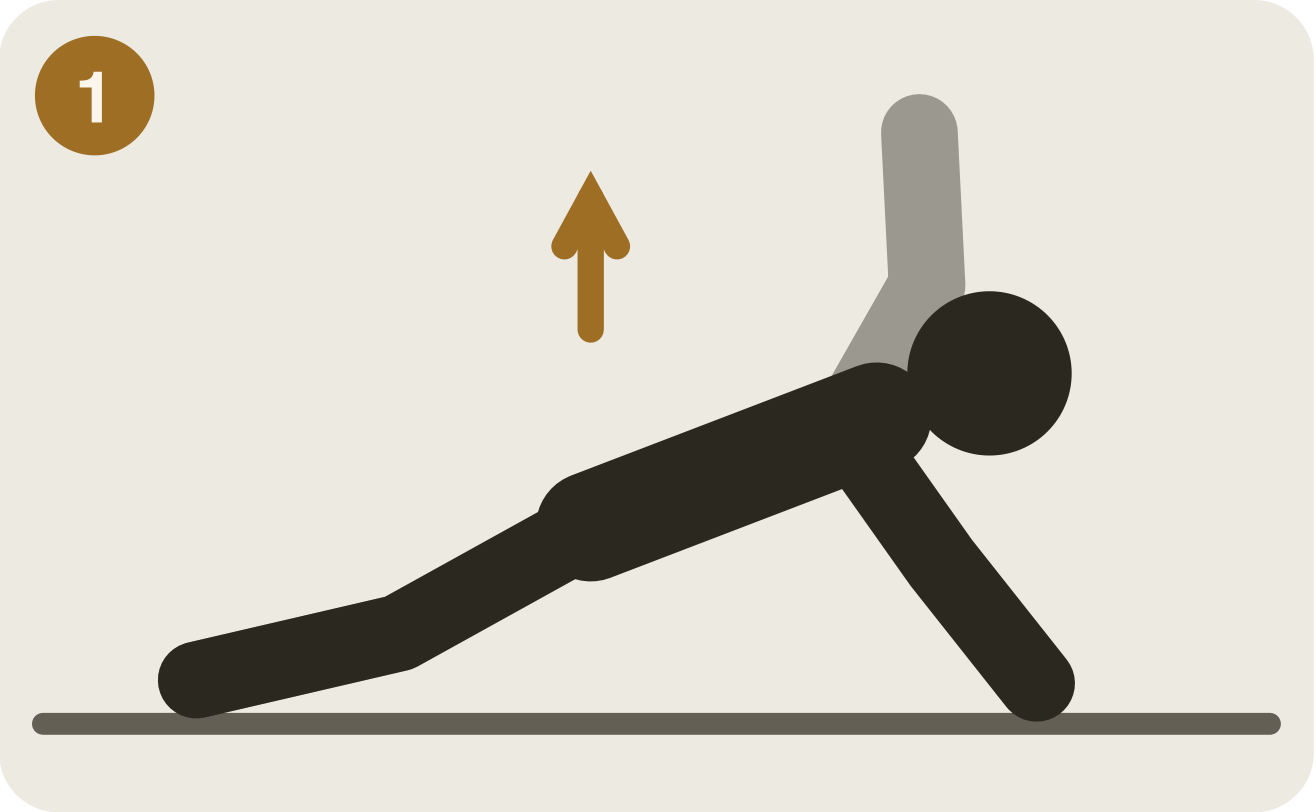
Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Plank" above.

Side plank with leg raise

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Elbow under shoulder, hips lifted in a straight line

Full-body focus plank

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Plank" above.

Kettlebell figure 8

Core · Strength · Loads: wrists/forearms, lower back.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Matrix lean back

Core · Strength · Loads: lower back.

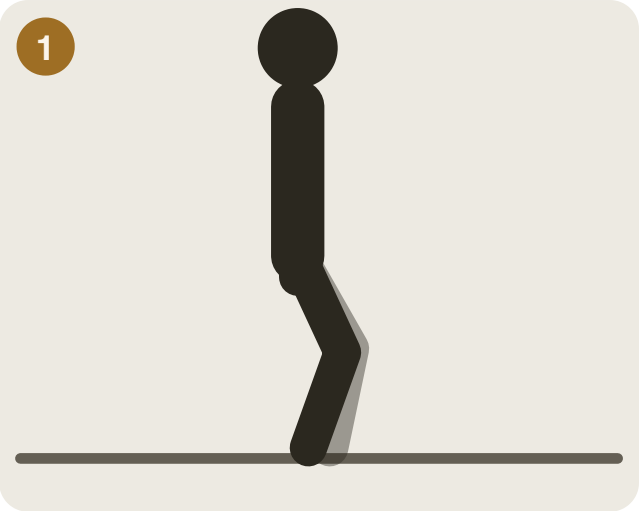
Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Leg Day

Squat/deadlift

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, lower back.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Stand tall, soft knees, ribs down
2. Push the hips back, flat back, hands slide down the thighs

Catcher calf raises

Calves/feet · Strength · Loads: ankles/feet.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Stand tall, feet flat
2. Rise onto the toes, pause, lower slowly

Calf jumps

Calves/feet · Strength · Loads: ankles/feet, knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Calf raise" above.

High stepping

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, ankles/feet.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Weighted box jumps

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, ankles/feet.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Bulgarian lunges

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, hips.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Long step, back knee drops straight down, torso tall

Hanging knee lifts

Core · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

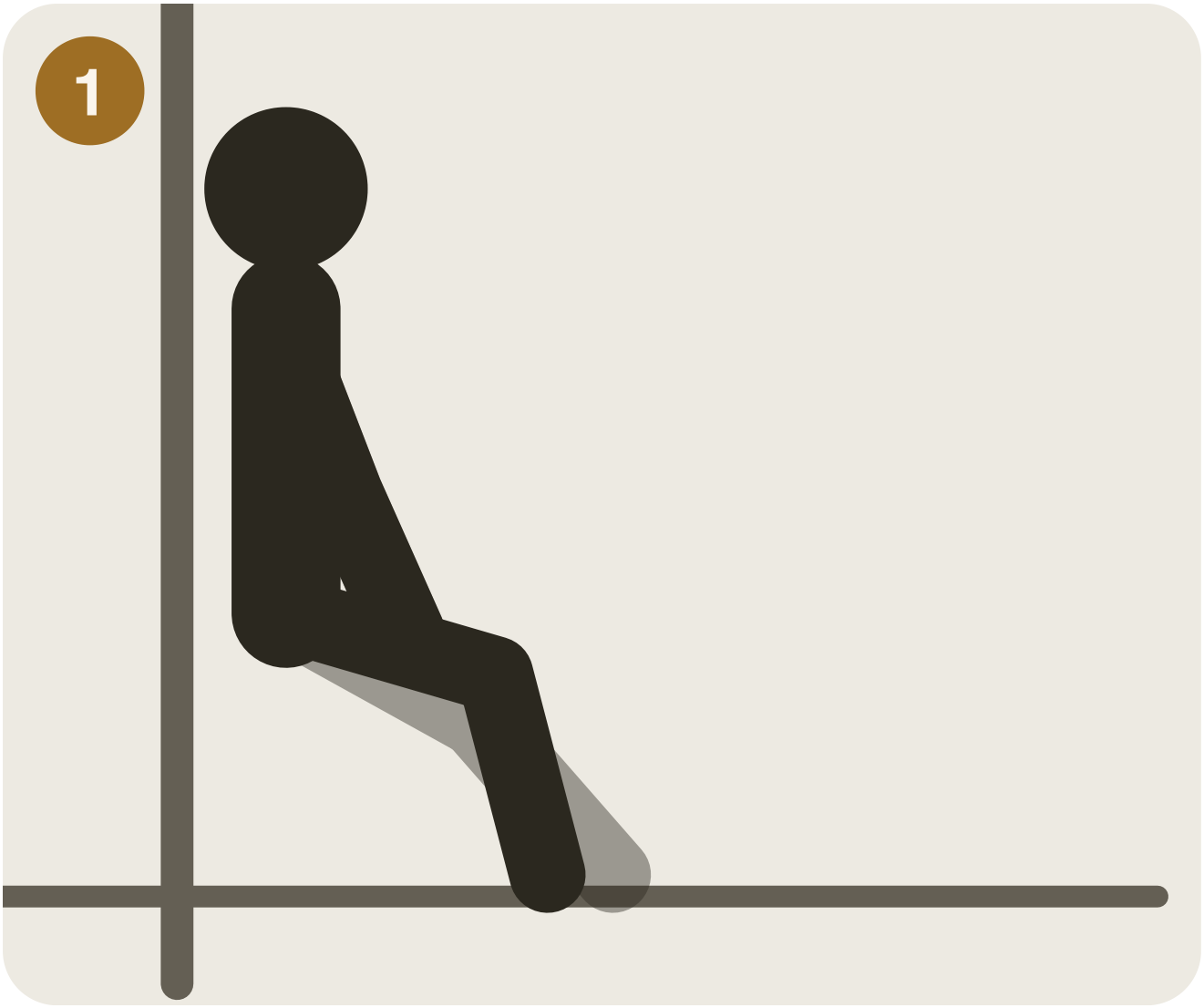
Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Hanging leg raise" above.

Wall sits

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Back flat on the wall, thighs level, knees over the ankles

Multidirectional lunges

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, hips.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Lunge" above.

Core-to-toe side lunges

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, hips.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Lunge" above.

Upper Tabata

Bent-over rows

Upper back · Strength · Loads: lower back, elbows, upper back/neck.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Lat pulldowns

Upper back · Strength · Loads: shoulders, elbows, upper back/neck.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Bicep curls

Elbows · Strength · Loads: elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Wrist curls

Wrists/forearms · Strength · Loads: wrists/forearms, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

TRX — Core

Body saw

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Side plank with hip raise

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Overhead squat

Full body · Strength · Loads: knees, shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

TRX — Shoulder

Clock press

Shoulders · Strength · Loads: shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

T-Y-I deltoid series

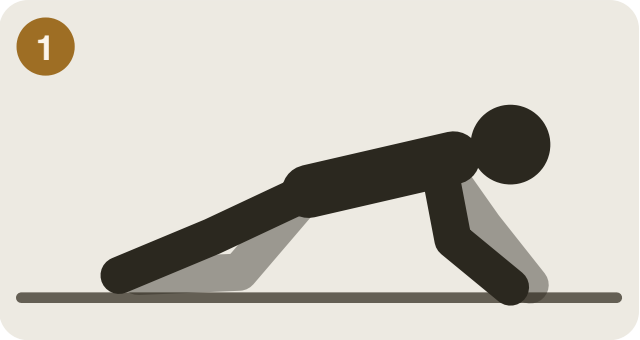
Shoulders · Prehab · Loads: shoulders.

Light and slow: one set of 5 to 10 reps, well short of fatigue. This is for the joints, not a workout.

Atomic pushups

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Hands under the shoulders, body one straight line
2. Lower with the elbows back until the chest is a fist from the floor

T-spine rotation

Upper back · Mobility · Loads: upper back/neck.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

Full Efficient Workout

Mountain mans (rope/pulley alternating lockouts)

Full body · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Campus board lunges

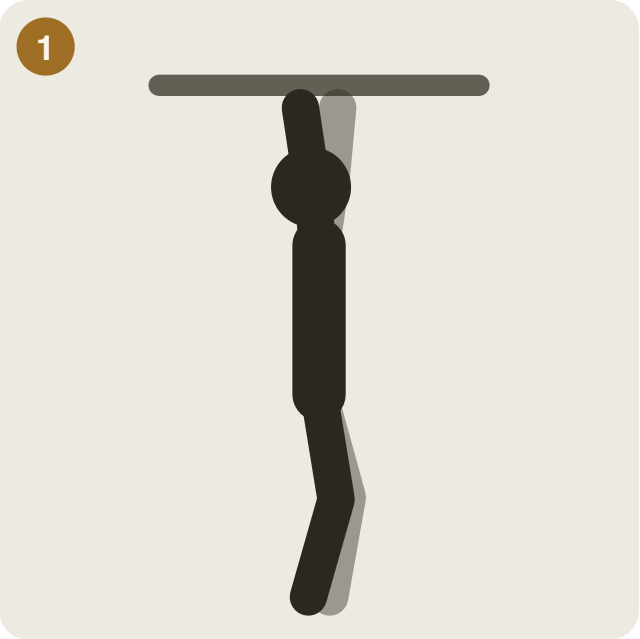
Full body · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Around-the-world pull-ups

Full body · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Hang from the bar with active shoulders, not sagging into them
2. Pull the elbows down until the chin clears the bar

Offset pull-ups

Full body · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Dead hang and pull-up" above.

Box jumps

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

One-leg squats

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Feet shoulder-width, sit down with heels flat and chest tall

Lunges with shoulder press

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Step-ups onto box

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Tucks

Core · Strength · Loads: no specific joint region.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Bridges

Hips · Strength · Loads: lower back, hips.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. On your back, knees bent, feet flat
2. Drive the hips up until shoulders, hips and knees line up

Side elbow planks

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Side plank" above.

Dip-bar leg raises

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Hanging leg raise" above.

Superman pushups

Full body · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Push-up" above.

Bicep/tricep work

Elbows · Strength · Loads: elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Chest/upper work

Shoulders · Strength · Loads: shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Forearm plank

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Plank" above.

Dolphin pushups

Full body · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Push-up" above.

One-arm planks

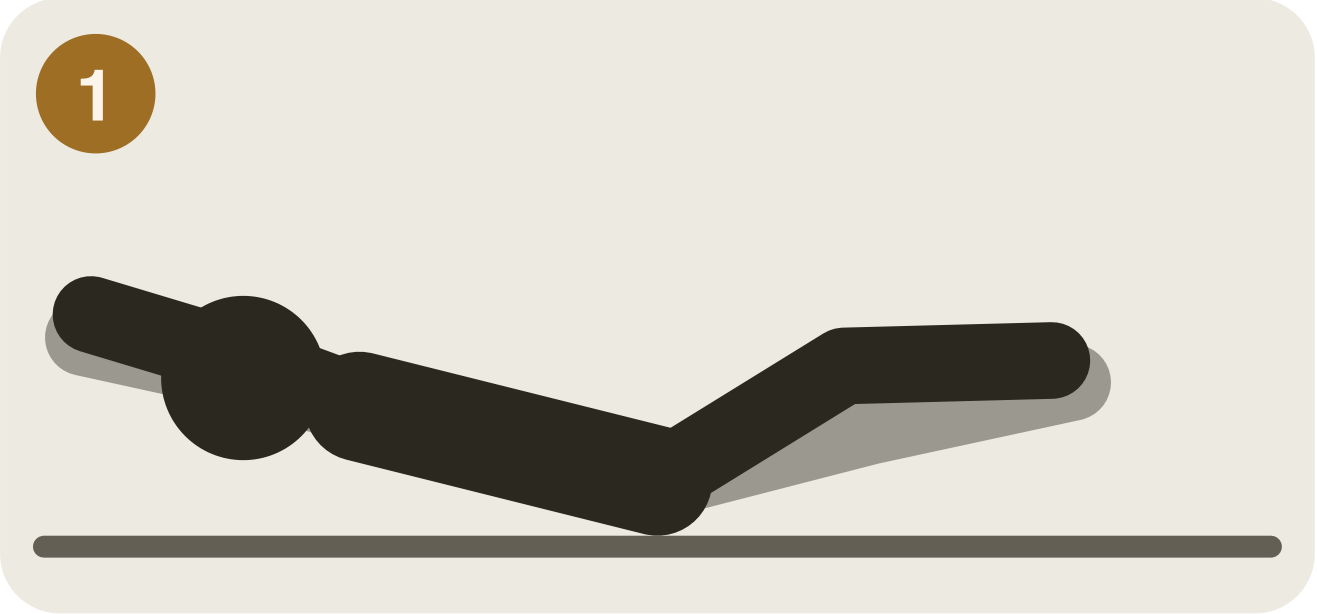
Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Toe touches

Core · Strength · Loads: lower back.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.



1. Low back pressed down, shoulders and legs just off the floor

Scissor kicks

Core · Strength · Loads: lower back.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Hollow hold" above.

Yoga Poses

Downward dog

Shoulders · Stretch · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Hands and feet on the floor, hips high, heels reaching down. Press the chest toward the thighs.

Child's pose

Lower back · Stretch · Loads: lower back.

Sit the hips back toward the heels and reach the arms long. Breathe into the back.

Pigeon pose

Hips · Stretch · Loads: knees, hips.

Front shin across the mat, back leg long behind. Fold over the front leg and breathe.

Warrior I

Legs · Stretch · Loads: knees.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Warrior II

Legs · Stretch · Loads: knees.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Triangle pose

Legs · Stretch · Loads: no specific joint region.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Cat-cow

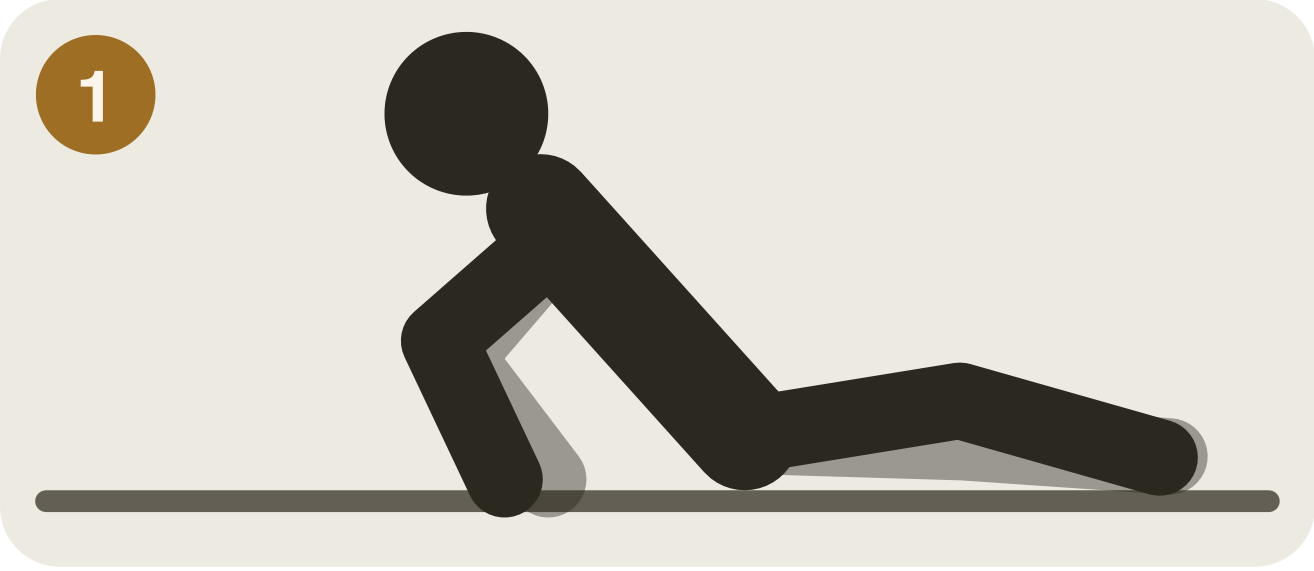
Lower back · Mobility · Loads: lower back.

On all fours, round the back, then arch it, moving with your breath.

Cobra pose

Lower back · Stretch · Loads: lower back, wrists/forearms.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.



1. Hands under the shoulders, press the chest forward and up

Seated forward fold

Legs · Stretch · Loads: lower back.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.



1. Legs long, hinge from the hips and reach toward the feet

Low lunge

Hips · Stretch · Loads: knees, hips.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Steps: see "Lunge" above.

Reclined spinal twist

Lower back · Stretch · Loads: lower back.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Happy baby pose

Hips · Stretch · Loads: hips.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Bridge pose

Hips · Mobility · Loads: hips.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

Steps: see "Glute bridge" above.

Thread-the-needle

Upper back · Stretch · Loads: shoulders, upper back/neck.

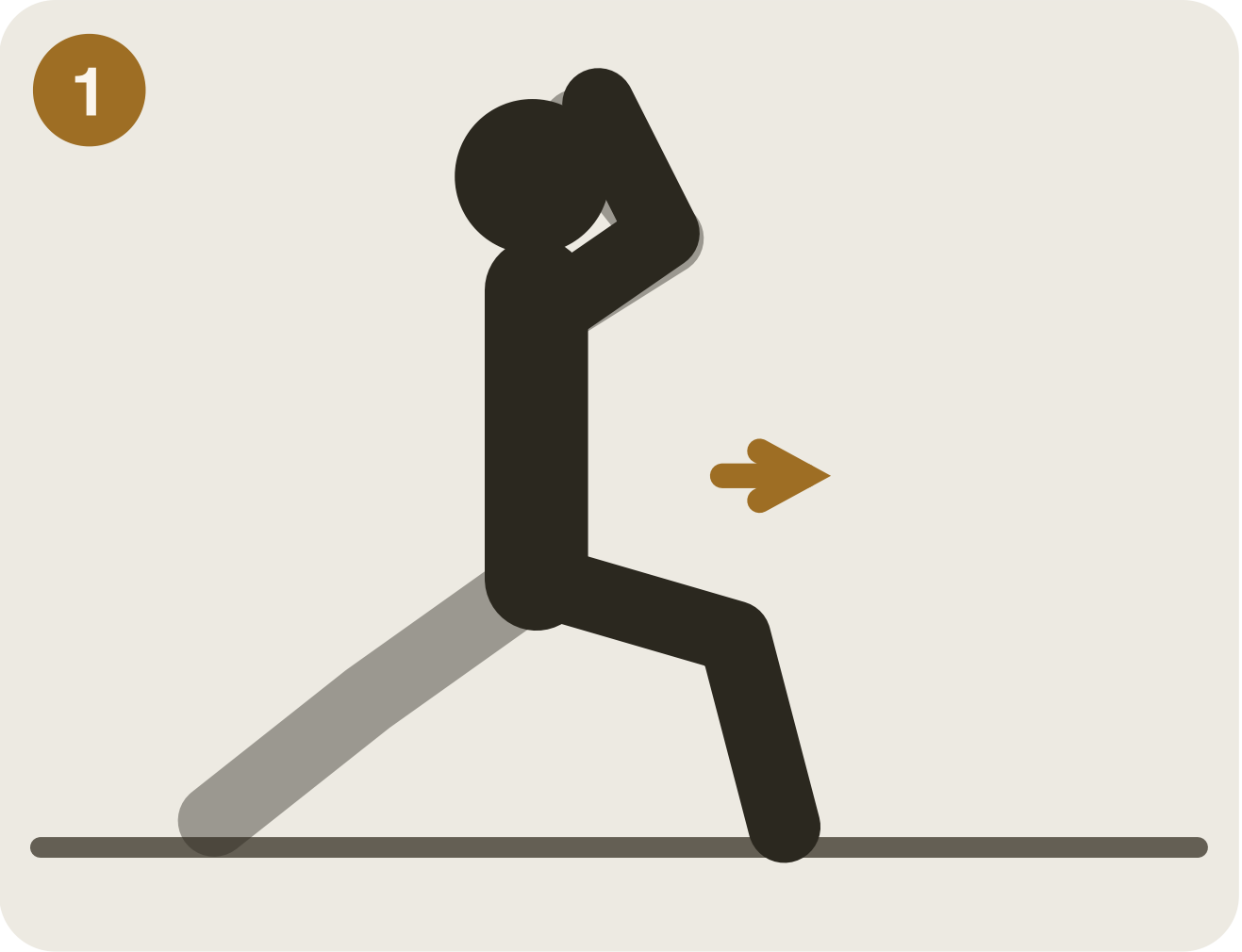
On all fours, slide one arm under the other and rest the shoulder and ear on the floor. Rotate back out.

Static Stretch

Hip flexor stretch

Hips · Stretch · Loads: hips.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.



1. Back knee down, tuck the tailbone, reach up on the same side

Hamstring stretch

Legs · Stretch · Loads: no specific joint region.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Steps: see "Seated forward fold" above.

Adductor stretch

Hips · Stretch · Loads: hips.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Rotator cuff stretch

Shoulders · Stretch · Loads: shoulders.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Chest/biceps doorway stretch

Shoulders · Stretch · Loads: shoulders.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Thoracic spine rotation

Upper back · Mobility · Loads: upper back/neck.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

Wrist mobility circles

Wrists/forearms · Mobility · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Fingers interlaced, make slow circles with both wrists in each direction.

Shoulder dislocates (band/stick)

Shoulders · Mobility · Loads: shoulders.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

90/90 hip switches

Hips · Mobility · Loads: knees, hips.

Sit with both knees bent at 90 degrees, then rotate both legs to the other side, keeping the torso tall.

Standing quad stretch

Legs · Stretch · Loads: knees.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Steps: see "Seated forward fold" above.

Calf stretch (wall)

Calves/feet · Stretch · Loads: no specific joint region.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Couch stretch (hip flexor)

Hips · Stretch · Loads: knees, hips.

Back shin up the wall, front foot forward. Tuck the tailbone and stand tall.

Steps: see "Hip flexor stretch" above.

Butterfly stretch

Hips · Stretch · Loads: hips.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Lat stretch (overhead reach)

Upper back · Stretch · Loads: upper back/neck.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Ankle dorsiflexion stretch

Calves/feet · Stretch · Loads: ankles/feet.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Seated spinal twist

Lower back · Stretch · Loads: lower back.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Neck rolls

Upper back · Stretch · Loads: upper back/neck.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Frog stretch

Hips · Stretch · Loads: knees, hips.

Hold about 30 seconds each side, breathing slowly. Ease off if anything pinches.

Foam Rolling

Foam roll — IT band

Legs · Release · Loads: no specific joint region.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Foam roll — quads

Legs · Release · Loads: no specific joint region.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Foam roll — lats

Upper back · Release · Loads: upper back/neck.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Foam roll — thoracic spine

Upper back · Release · Loads: upper back/neck.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Foam roll — calves

Calves/feet · Release · Loads: no specific joint region.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Foam roll — glutes

Hips · Release · Loads: hips.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Foam roll — upper back

Upper back · Release · Loads: upper back/neck.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Lacrosse Ball Release

Lacrosse ball — glutes

Hips · Release · Loads: hips.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Lacrosse ball — feet/plantar fascia

Calves/feet · Release · Loads: no specific joint region.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Lacrosse ball — pecs

Shoulders · Release · Loads: shoulders.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Lacrosse ball — forearms

Wrists/forearms · Release · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Lacrosse ball — traps/upper back

Upper back · Release · Loads: upper back/neck.

Roll or press slowly for 30 to 60 seconds on tender spots. Stay below sharp pain.

Functional Movement

Squat-to-stand

Legs · Mobility · Loads: knees.

From a deep squat grab the toes, straighten the legs, then drop back down.



1. Sit down into a deep squat, hands together in front
2. Stay low, open the chest and reach one arm overhead

Inchworm to plank

Full body · Mobility · Loads: wrists/forearms.

From standing, walk the hands out to a plank, then walk them back and stand up.

Animal flow — bear crawl

Full body · Mobility · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Knees an inch off the floor, crawl forward with opposite hand and foot together.

Turkish get-up (bodyweight)

Full body · Mobility · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Lying down, roll to the elbow, then hand, lift the hips, step back to a lunge and stand, eyes on the fist.

Loaded carry (farmer/suitcase)

Full body · Mobility · Loads: fingers, wrists/forearms.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

Crawling patterns

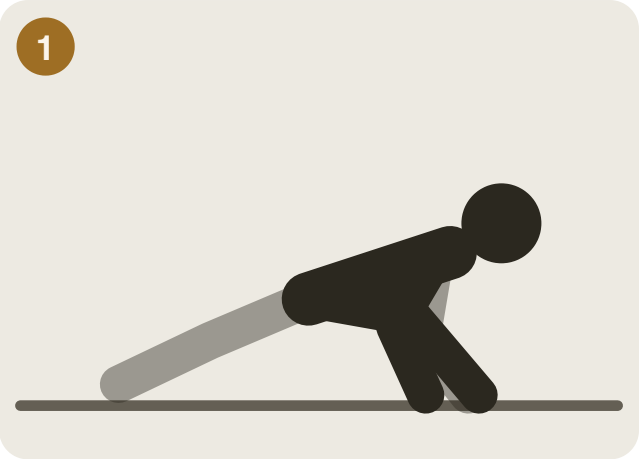
Full body · Mobility · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

World's greatest stretch (full combo)

Hips · Mobility · Loads: hips.

Long lunge, hands inside the front foot, rotate and reach one arm up, then sit the hips back. Both sides.



1. Long lunge, both hands down inside the front foot
2. Rotate open and reach one arm to the sky

Windmills

Lower back · Mobility · Loads: lower back.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

Scorpion stretch

Lower back · Mobility · Loads: lower back.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

Body Prep

Joint circles (ankles/hips/shoulders)

Full body · Mobility · Loads: no specific joint region.

Slow, full circles at each joint, a few each way. Just enough to feel it warm up.

Arm circles

Shoulders · Mobility · Loads: shoulders.

Arms out, small circles growing to large, both directions.

Leg swings (front-back)

Hips · Mobility · Loads: hips.

Hold something for balance and swing the leg freely forward and back, a little higher each swing.

Leg swings (side-side)

Hips · Mobility · Loads: hips.

Hold something for balance and swing the leg across the body and out to the side.

Hip circles

Hips · Mobility · Loads: hips.

Hands on hips, draw big slow circles with the pelvis, then reverse.

Walking lunges with twist

Legs · Mobility · Loads: knees.

Smooth, easy range. Move into it, do not force it.

Steps: see "Lunge" above.

High knees march

Legs · Cardio · Loads: no specific joint region.

March in place, driving the knees to hip height with an upright chest.

Band pull-aparts

Upper back · Prehab · Loads: upper back/neck.

Arms straight in front, pull the band apart to chest level by squeezing the shoulder blades.

Wall slides

Shoulders · Prehab · Loads: shoulders.

Forearms on the wall, slide them up as you stand tall, keeping the ribs down.

Cardio Circuit

Jump rope

Full body · Cardio · Loads: ankles/feet, knees.

A steady effort you could still talk through, with tidy form.

Rowing intervals

Full body · Cardio · Loads: lower back.

A steady effort you could still talk through, with tidy form.

Stair sprints

Full body · Cardio · Loads: knees.

A steady effort you could still talk through, with tidy form.

Suicide sprints

Full body · Cardio · Loads: knees, ankles/feet.

A steady effort you could still talk through, with tidy form.

Incline treadmill walk

Full body · Cardio · Loads: no specific joint region.

A steady effort you could still talk through, with tidy form.

Bike intervals

Full body · Cardio · Loads: knees.

A steady effort you could still talk through, with tidy form.

Burpees

Full body · Cardio · Loads: wrists/forearms, shoulders, knees.

A steady effort you could still talk through, with tidy form.

Fingers

Finger hangs

Fingers · Fingers · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Warm up first. Hang from a comfortable edge with shoulders active and stop before the fingers fatigue.

Finger pull-ups

Fingers · Fingers · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Warm up first. Stop at any sharp pain in the fingers or elbows.

Steps: see "Dead hang and pull-up" above.

Finger planks

Fingers · Fingers · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Warm up first. Stop at any sharp pain in the fingers or elbows.

Hangboard repeaters

Fingers · Fingers · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Warm up first. Stop at any sharp pain in the fingers or elbows.

Minimum-edge hangs

Fingers · Fingers · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Warm up first. Stop at any sharp pain in the fingers or elbows.

Fingerboard moving hangs

Fingers · Fingers · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Warm up first. Stop at any sharp pain in the fingers or elbows.

HIT System (max-strength hangs)

Fingers · Fingers · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Warm up first. Stop at any sharp pain in the fingers or elbows.

Wrist curls (health/prehab)

Wrists/forearms · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Light weight, forearm supported. Curl the wrist up and lower slowly, a few light reps.

Finger extensions (rubber band)

Fingers · Prehab · Loads: fingers.

Band around the fingers and thumb. Open the hand against it slowly, then close slowly.

Prehab

Band external rotation

Shoulders · Prehab · Loads: shoulders.

Elbow pinned to your side at 90 degrees. Turn the forearm outward against the band, slowly, then return.

Scapular push-ups

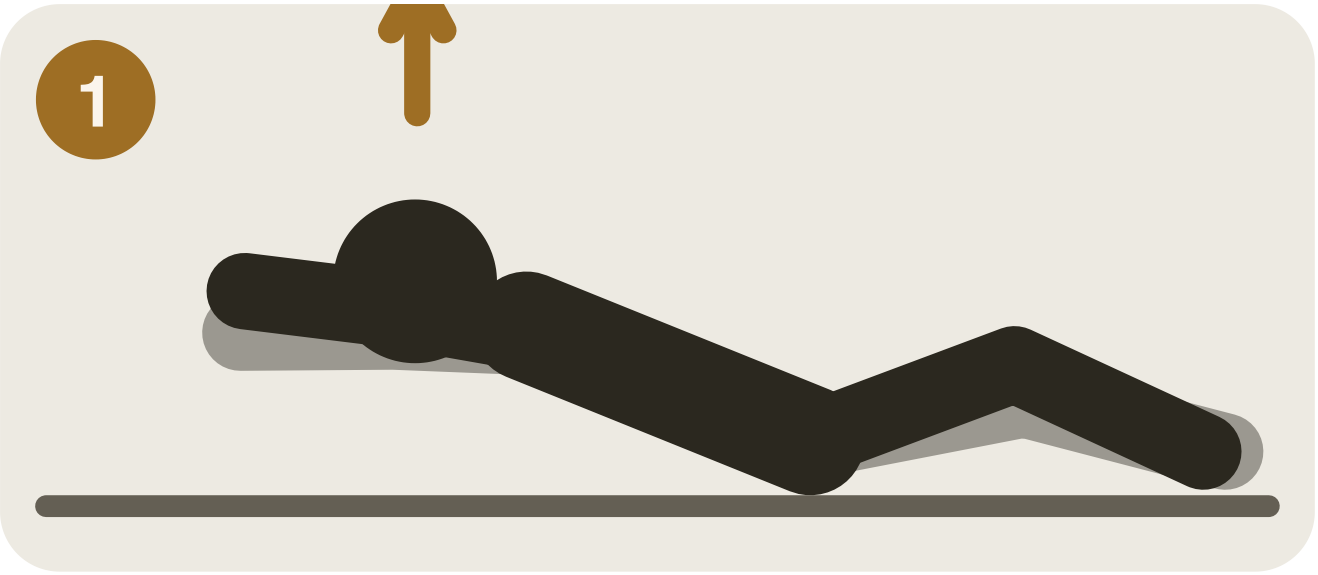
Shoulders · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms, shoulders.

In a plank with straight arms, let the chest sink between the shoulder blades, then push them apart. Only the shoulder blades move.

Prone Y raises

Upper back · Prehab · Loads: upper back/neck.

Face down, thumbs up, lift the arms in a Y by squeezing between the shoulder blades. Do not arch the back.



1. Face down, arms long. Lift the chest and arms, squeeze the shoulder blades

Prone T raises

Upper back · Prehab · Loads: upper back/neck.

Face down, arms out to the sides like a T, lift by squeezing the shoulder blades together.

Steps: see "Prone cobra" above.

Wall angels

Shoulders · Prehab · Loads: shoulders.

Back, hips and forearms on the wall. Slide the arms up and down, keeping contact the whole way.

Face pulls (band)

Upper back · Prehab · Loads: upper back/neck.

Pull the band toward the face with the elbows high and wide, finishing with the hands beside the ears.

Reverse wrist curls

Wrists/forearms · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Forearm on a thigh, palm down. Lift the back of the hand slowly and lower it slowly, with a light weight.

Wrist pronation-supination (light weight)

Wrists/forearms · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Elbow at your side, hold a light weight. Rotate the palm up, then down, slowly.

Radial-ulnar deviation (light weight)

Wrists/forearms · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Forearm supported, hold a light weight. Tilt the hand toward the thumb side, then the little-finger side.

Band wrist extensions

Wrists/forearms · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms.

Forearm supported, palm down, band around the hand. Lift the hand against the band slowly.

Eccentric wrist extensions (slow lower)

Elbows · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms, elbows.

Lift the hand up with the other hand, then lower it to the count of five on your own.

Band triceps extensions

Elbows · Prehab · Loads: elbows.

Elbows tucked, straighten the arms against the band, then return slowly.

Prone cobra

Upper back · Prehab · Loads: lower back, upper back/neck.

Face down, lift the chest and arms a few inches and squeeze the shoulder blades. Hold a moment.

Steps: see "Prone cobra" above.

Clamshells

Hips · Prehab · Loads: hips.

On your side, knees bent, feet together. Open the top knee without rolling the pelvis back.

Banded lateral walks

Hips · Prehab · Loads: knees, hips.

Band above the knees, small knee bend. Step sideways with control, keeping the toes forward.

Glute bridges

Hips · Prehab · Loads: lower back, hips.

On your back, feet flat. Drive the hips up until shoulders, hips and knees line up, then lower slowly.

Steps: see "Glute bridge" above.

Fire hydrants

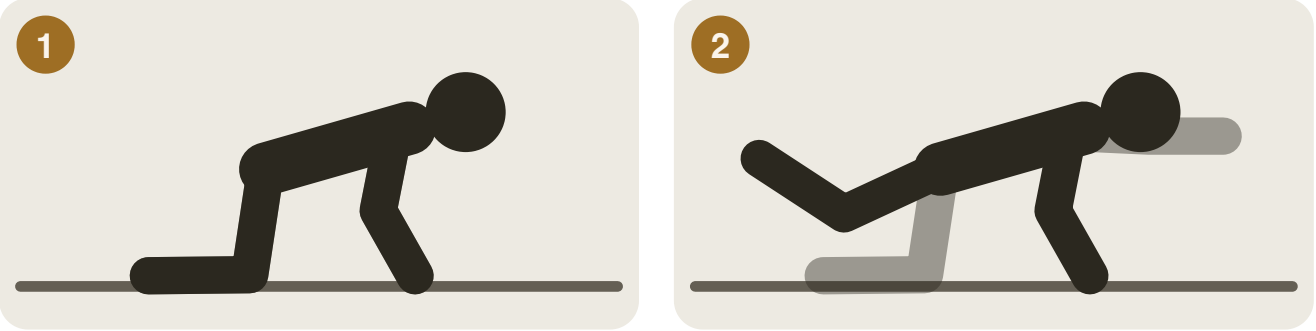
Hips · Prehab · Loads: hips.

On all fours, lift one knee out to the side without twisting the trunk, then lower.

Bird dog

Core · Prehab · Loads: wrists/forearms.

On all fours, reach one arm forward and the opposite leg back, keeping the hips level.

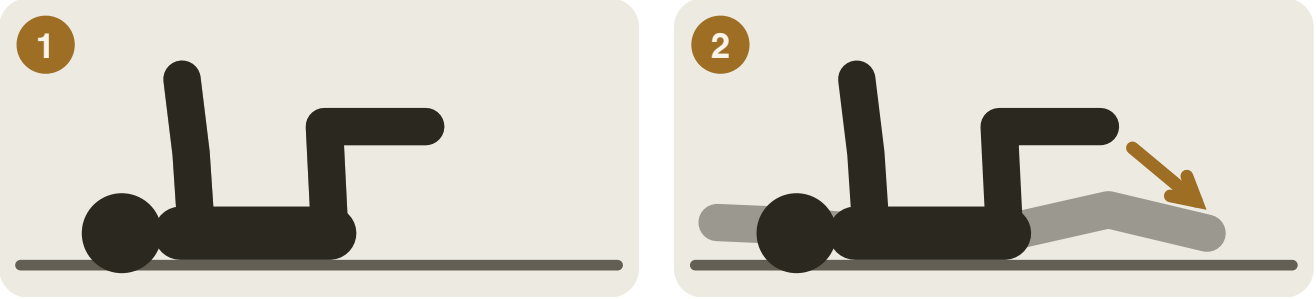


1. On hands and knees, back flat
2. Reach one arm forward and the opposite leg back

Dead bug

Core · Prehab · Loads: no specific joint region.

On your back, arms up and knees over the hips. Lower the opposite arm and leg while the low back stays flat.



1. On your back, arms up, knees over hips
2. Lower the opposite arm and leg together, back flat

Terminal knee extensions (band)

Legs · Prehab · Loads: knees.

Band behind the knee, slight bend. Straighten the knee fully against the band and squeeze the thigh.

Tibialis raises

Calves/feet · Prehab · Loads: no specific joint region.

Heels on the floor, back against a wall. Lift the toes toward the shins, then lower.

Short-foot exercise

Calves/feet · Prehab · Loads: no specific joint region.

Without curling the toes, draw the ball of the foot toward the heel to lift the arch.

Single-leg balance

Calves/feet · Prehab · Loads: no specific joint region.

Stand on one leg, eyes on a fixed point. Keep the hips level and the knee soft.



1. Stand tall on one leg, hands on hips, eyes on a spot (then closed)

General/Other

Hanging leg raises

Core · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows.

Hang from the bar and lift the legs to hip height without swinging, then lower with control.

Steps: see "Hanging leg raise" above.

Pistol squats

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Deep squat hold" above.

Raised-leg diamond pushups

Full body · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms, elbows.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Push-up" above.

Jumping lunges

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Lunge" above.

Lateral pull-ups

Upper back · Strength · Loads: fingers, shoulders, elbows, upper back/neck.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Dead hang and pull-up" above.

Upside-down shoulder press

Shoulders · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Tricep dips

Elbows · Strength · Loads: shoulders, elbows, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Incline pushups

Shoulders · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Push-up" above.

Chair ups

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Deep squat hold" above.

Stair jumps

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, ankles/feet.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Front squats

Legs · Strength · Loads: knees, wrists/forearms, lower back.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Steps: see "Deep squat hold" above.

Turkish getup

Full body · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Straight-arm planks

Core · Strength · Loads: shoulders, wrists/forearms.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Shoulder dislocates

Full body · Strength · Loads: no specific joint region.

Controlled reps, smooth up and down. Stop one or two reps before your form breaks.

Drill library

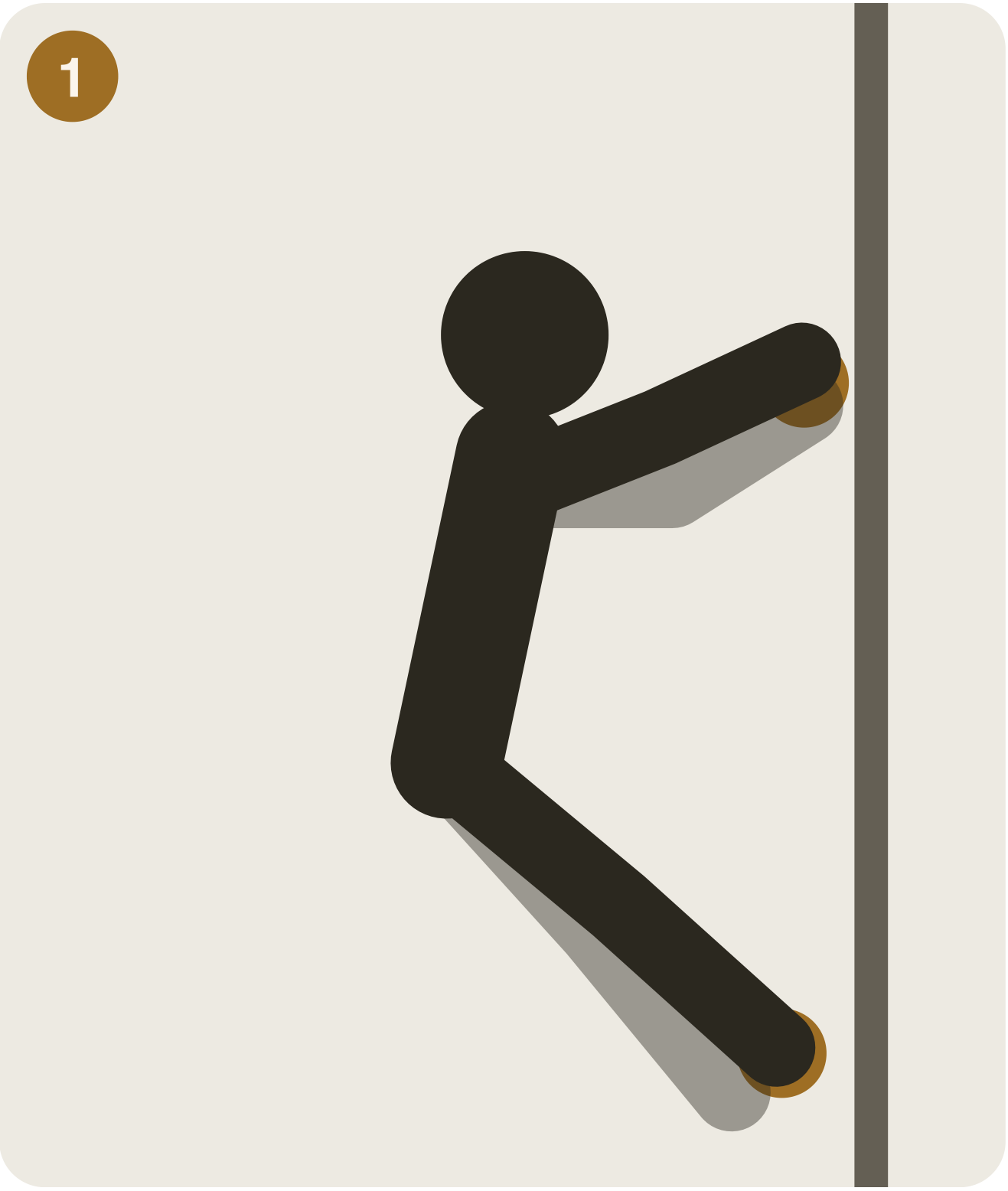
Coach deck

24 drills the plans pick from.

Sloth & Monkey

warmup · control · **3 easy problems, each twice**

Climb each problem once as slowly and statically as you can (sloth), then once with big, swingy dynamic movement (monkey). Notice which style feels less natural and spend a little extra time there.

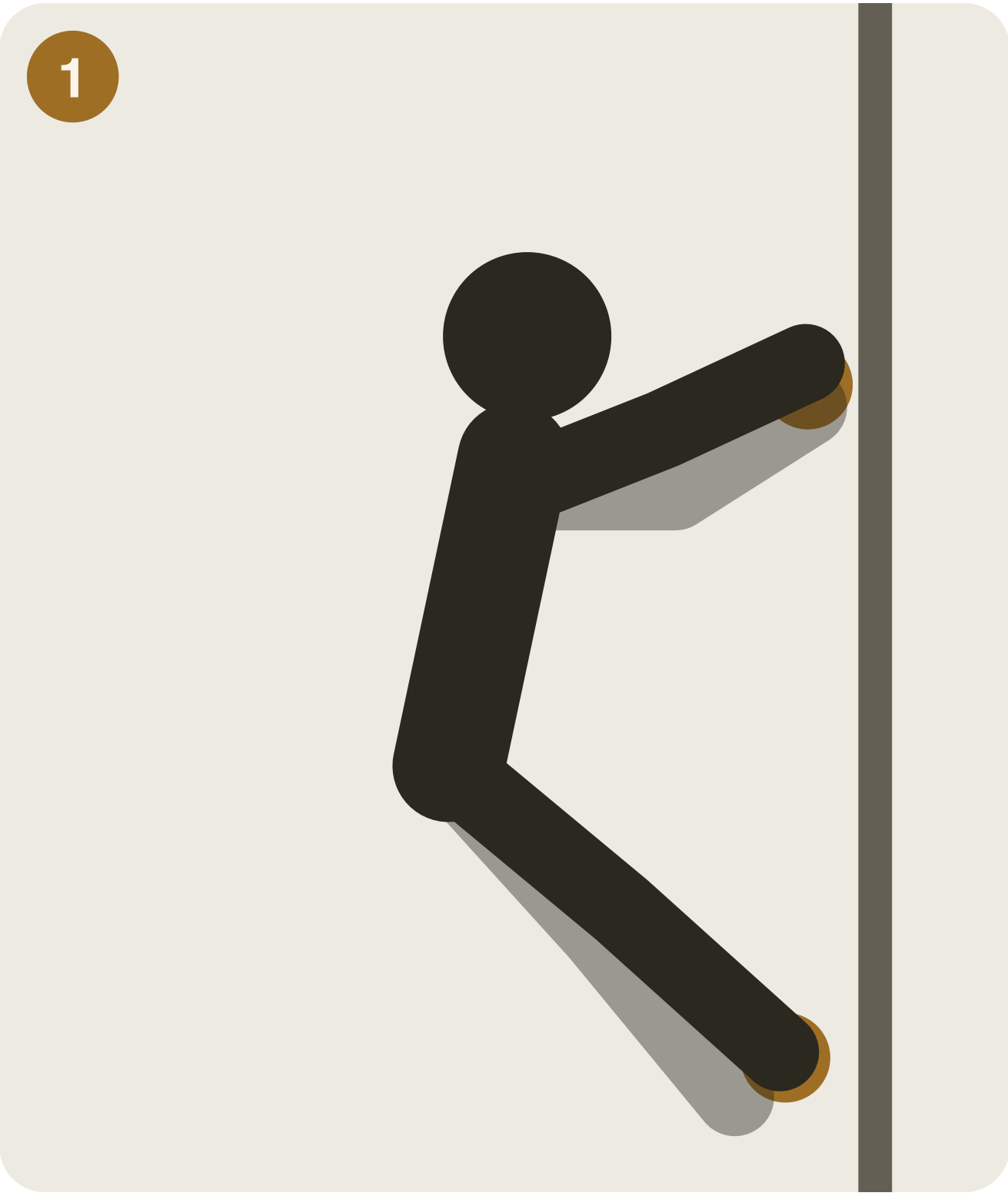


1. Arms straight, hang off the skeleton and move by turning the hips

Three-finger sloth

warmup · control · **1-2 easy jug problems**

Climb slowly using only the middle three fingers on each hold, hands open and extended, arms as straight as you can keep them. Builds an efficient, relaxed grab.

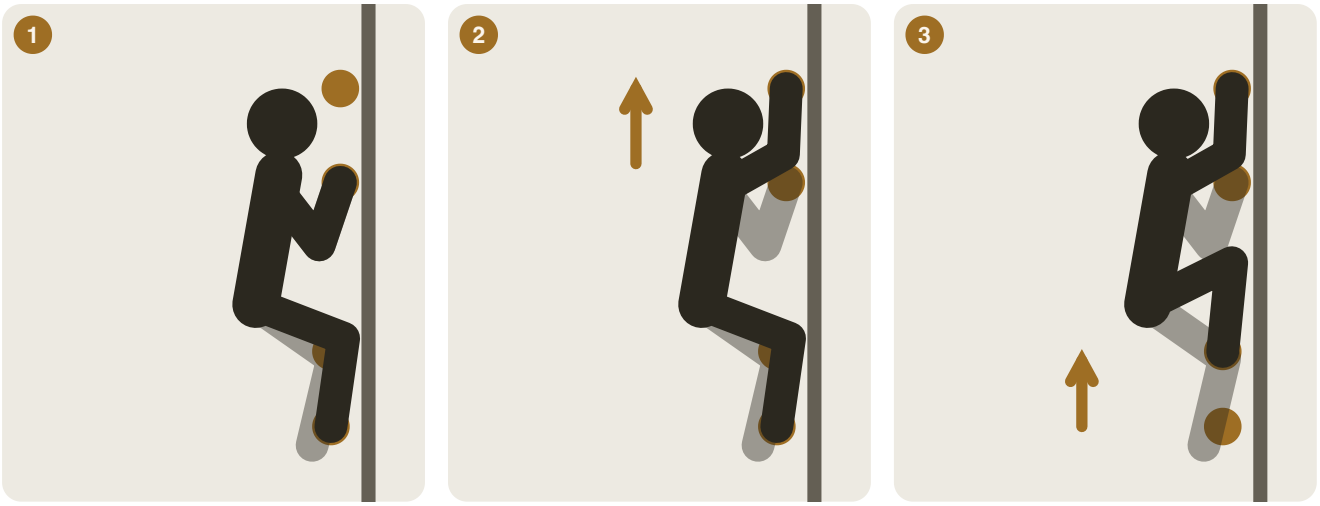


1. Arms straight, hang off the skeleton and move by turning the hips

Robot drill

warmup · control · technique · **2-3 easy problems**

Move one limb at a time. The rest of the body stays completely still until that limb has settled on the next hold or position, then the next limb goes.

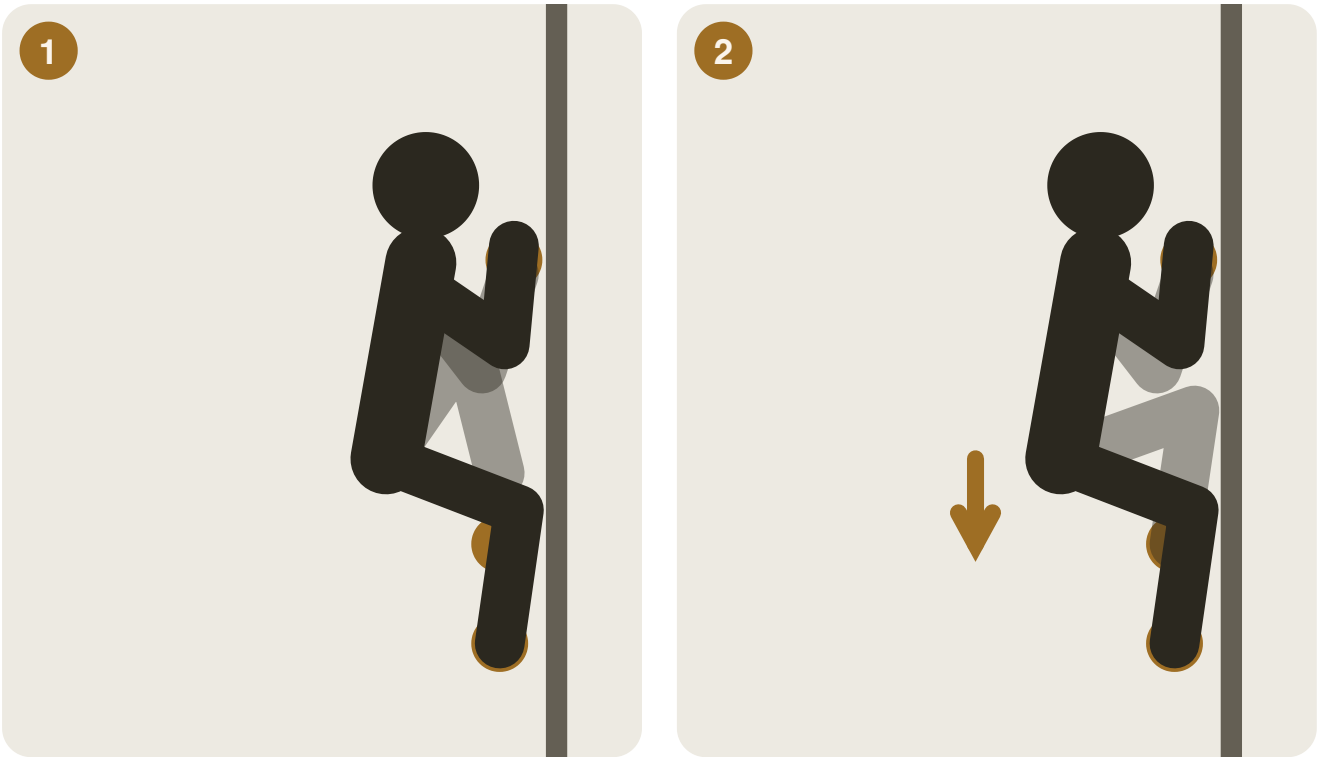


1. Start balanced, all four limbs on holds
2. Move one hand only. Everything else stays still
3. Settled? Now one foot only, to the next hold

Silent feet

warmup · footwork · **3-4 easy problems**

Place every foot so quietly that nobody could hear it. Make contact slowly with a relaxed ankle and the smallest imprint on the hold.

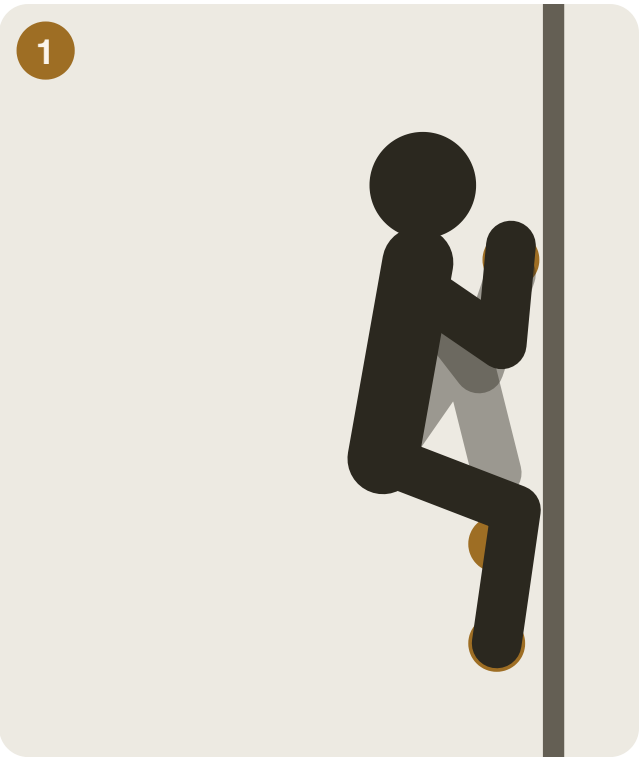


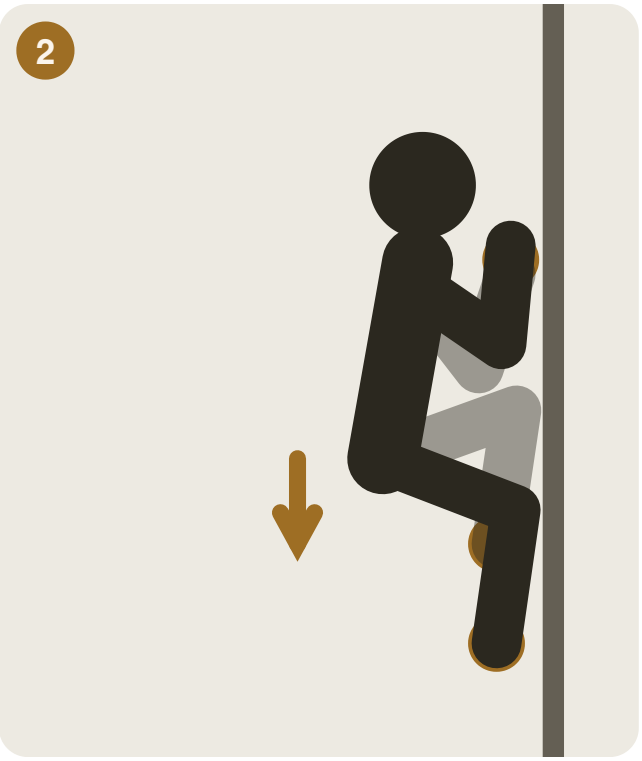
1. Hover the toe above the hold for a moment
2. Place it slowly and quietly, with a relaxed ankle

Glue feet

footwork · control · **3 problems**

Once a foot lands on a hold it stays put until the next move makes you shift it. Forces you to place it right the first time.



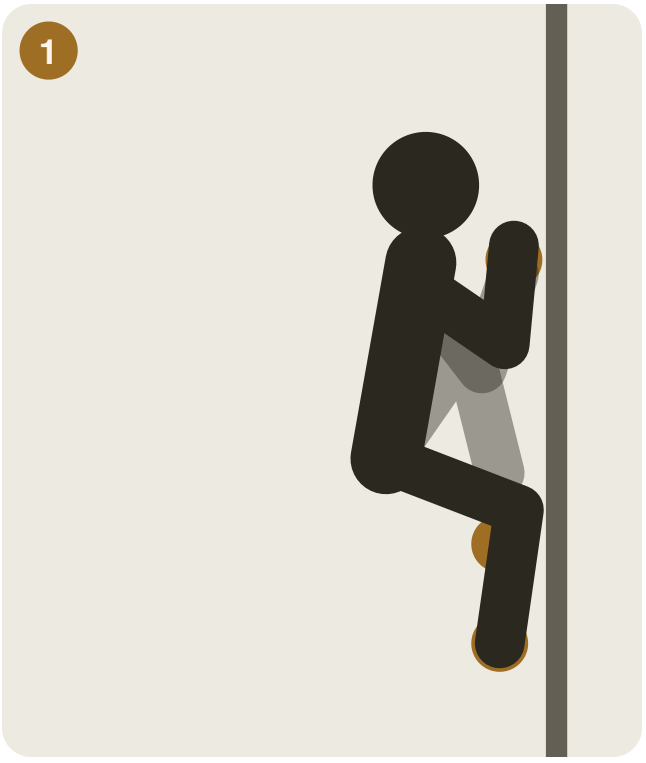


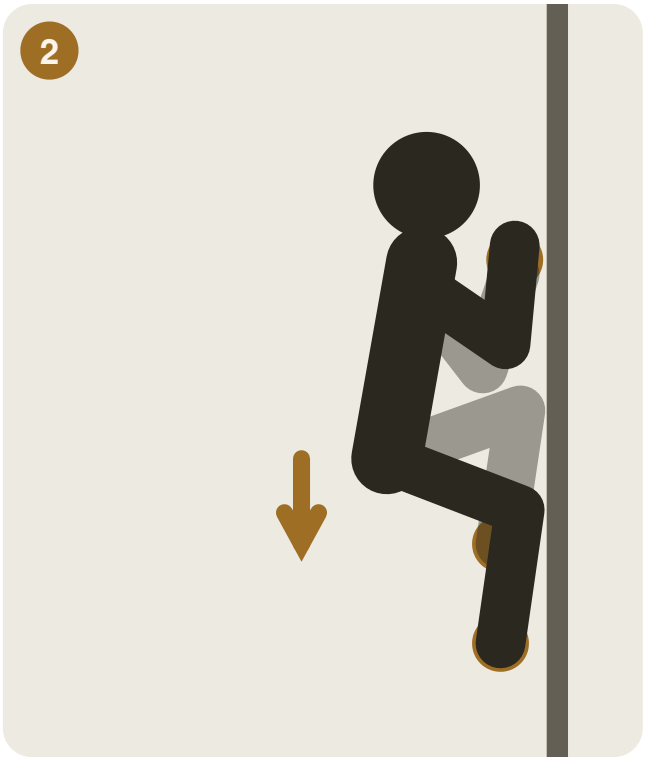
1. Hover the toe above the hold for a moment
2. Place it slowly and quietly, with a relaxed ankle

Hover feet

warmup · footwork · **3 easy problems**

Hold your toe just above each foothold for about three seconds, then place it. Builds the habit of landing precisely once instead of fixing it afterwards.



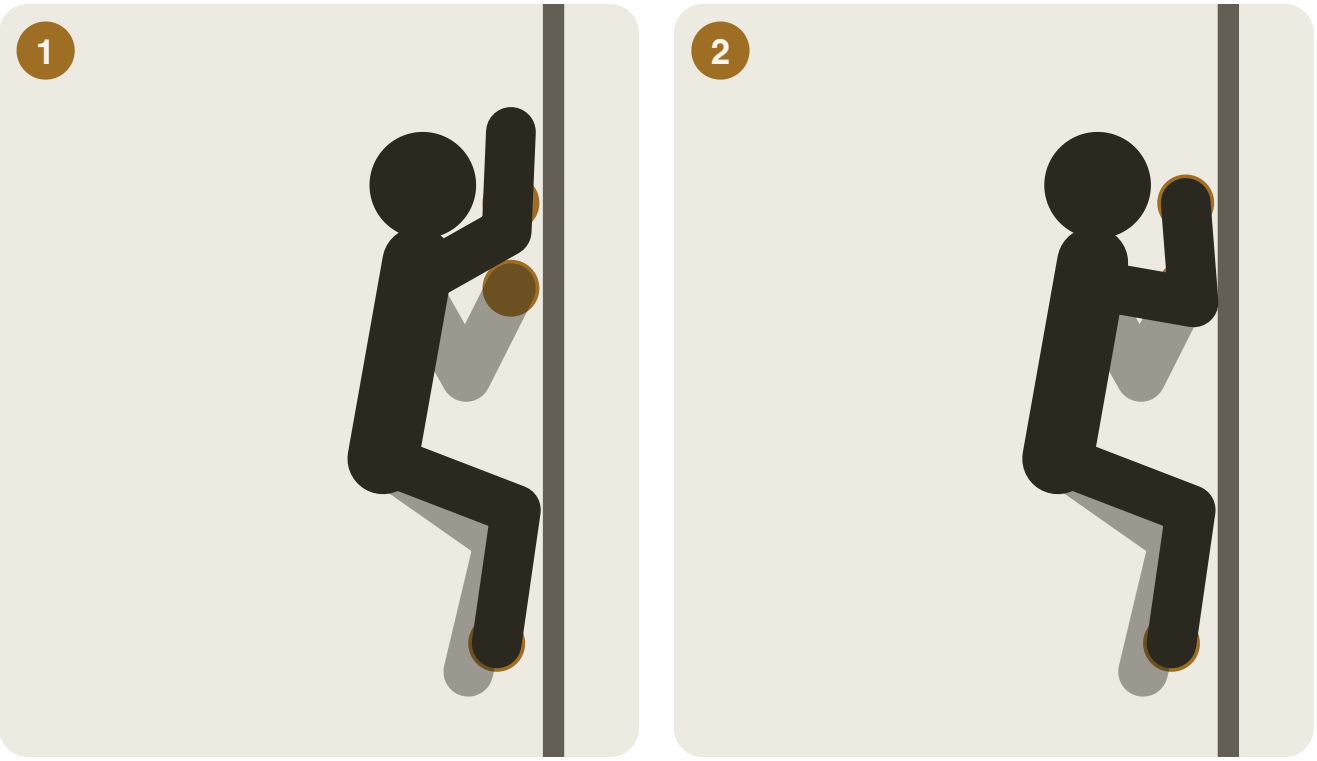


1. Hover the toe above the hold for a moment
2. Place it slowly and quietly, with a relaxed ankle

Hover hands

control · warmup · **2-3 easy problems**

Hold each hand just above the next hold for about three seconds before taking it. Trains body tension and control between holds.



1. Hold the hand just above the next hold for about three seconds
2. Then take it, keeping the body tight and still

One touch

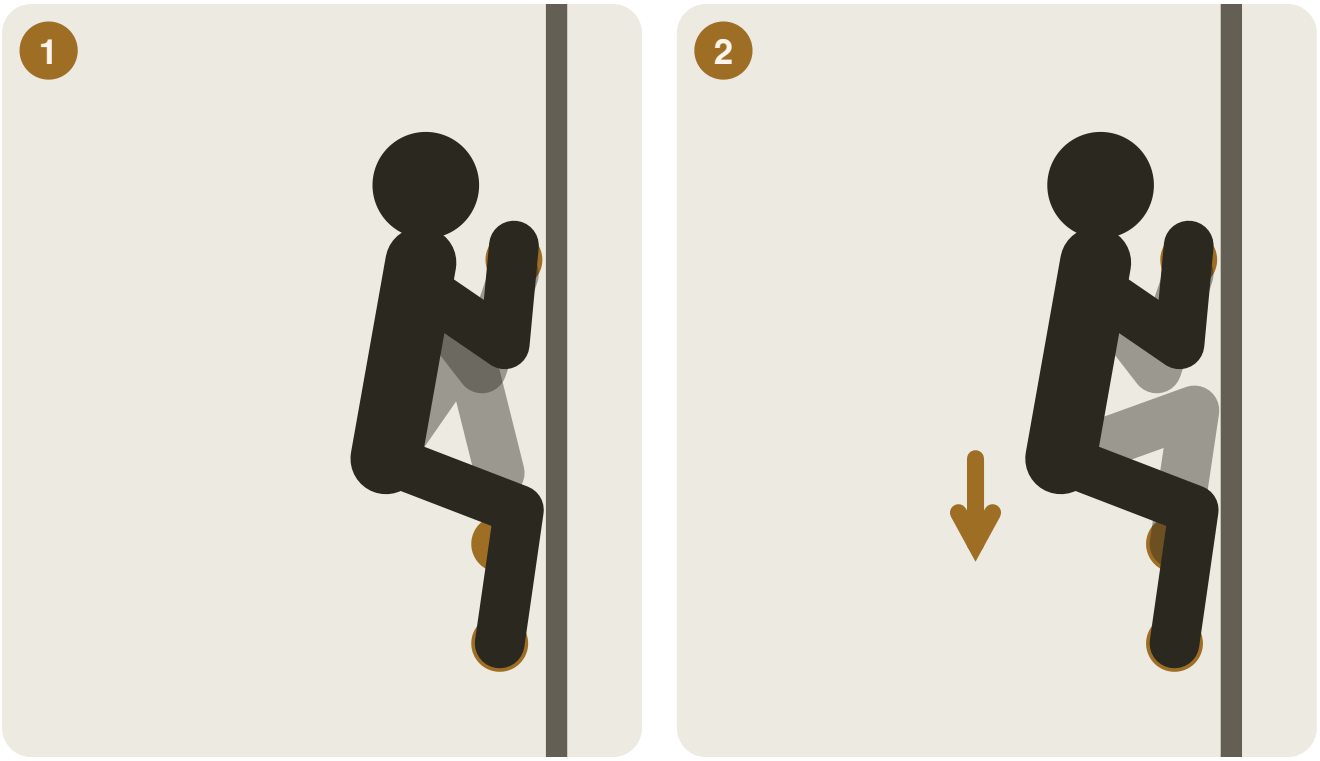
control · footwork · **3-4 problems below your limit**

Each hand and foot touches each hold once. No readjusting a bad placement, and your eyes stay on the next hold until it is latched.

Eyes on feet

footwork · warmup · **3 easy problems**

Look at every foothold before you step on it and keep looking for about two seconds after it lands. Fixes stepping without really seeing the hold.



1. Hover the toe above the hold for a moment
2. Place it slowly and quietly, with a relaxed ankle

Pause every move

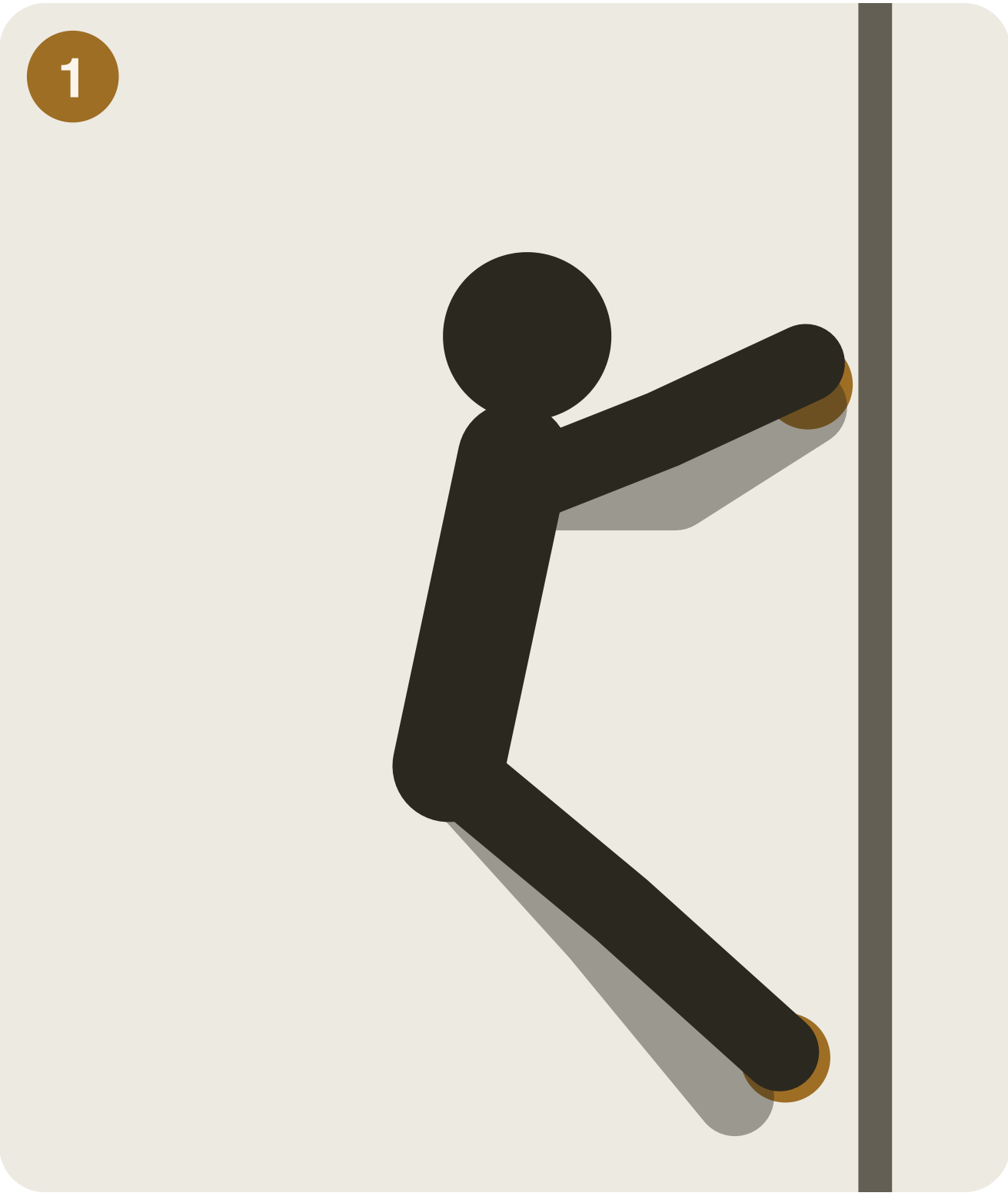
control · **2-3 problems, up and down**

Hold a clean, still position for three seconds after each move before reaching for the next hold. Exposes where you rely on momentum.

Straight-arm traverse

control · technique · **2-3 laps of an easy traverse**

Traverse with your arms as straight as possible and move by rotating and shifting the hips. Hang off the skeleton, not the biceps.

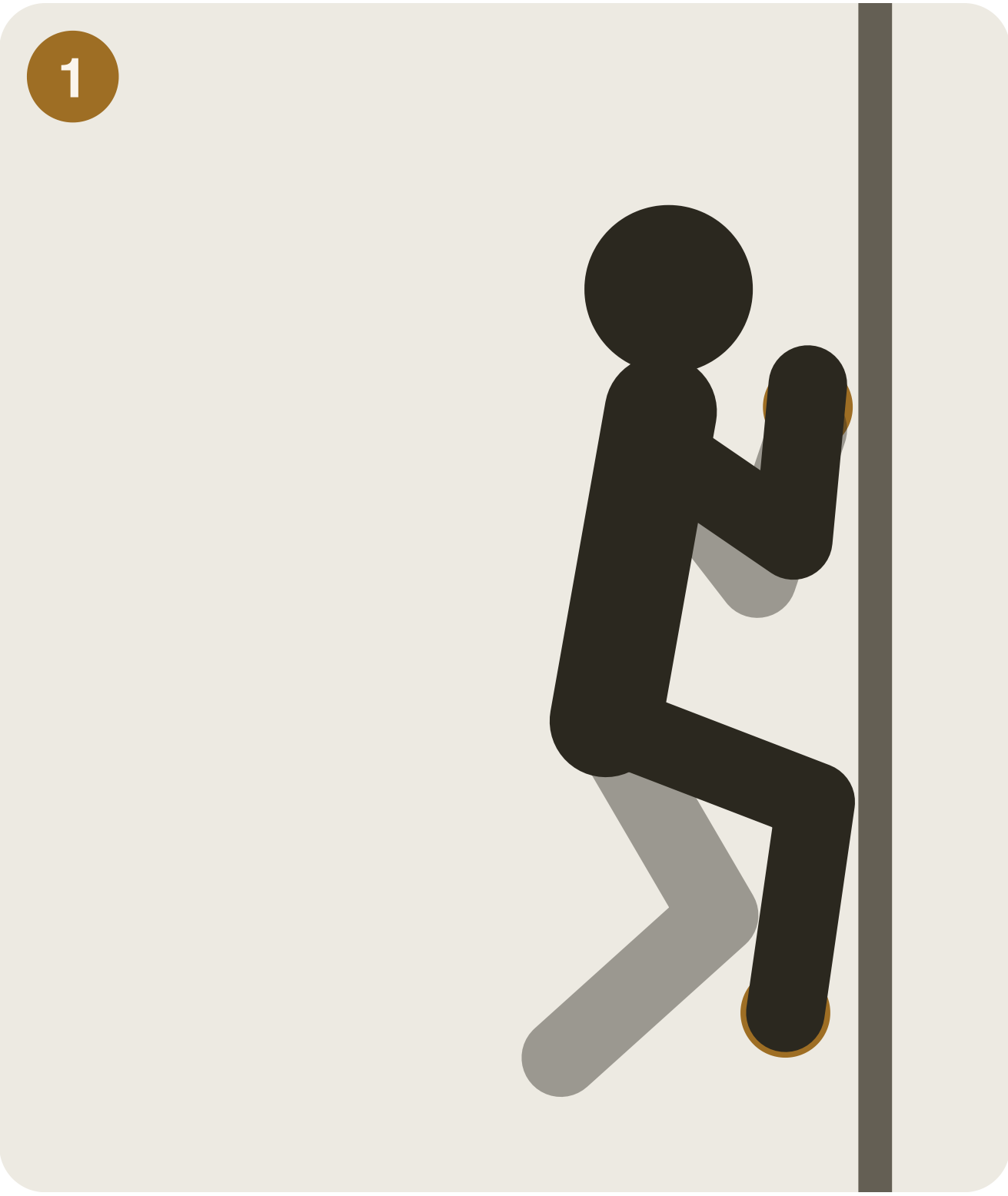


1. Arms straight, hang off the skeleton and move by turning the hips

One-hand traverse

control · **2 laps per hand, slab or vertical**

Use one hand only, the other hangs at your side. Each time a hand leaves the wall, find a stable body position for a second or two.

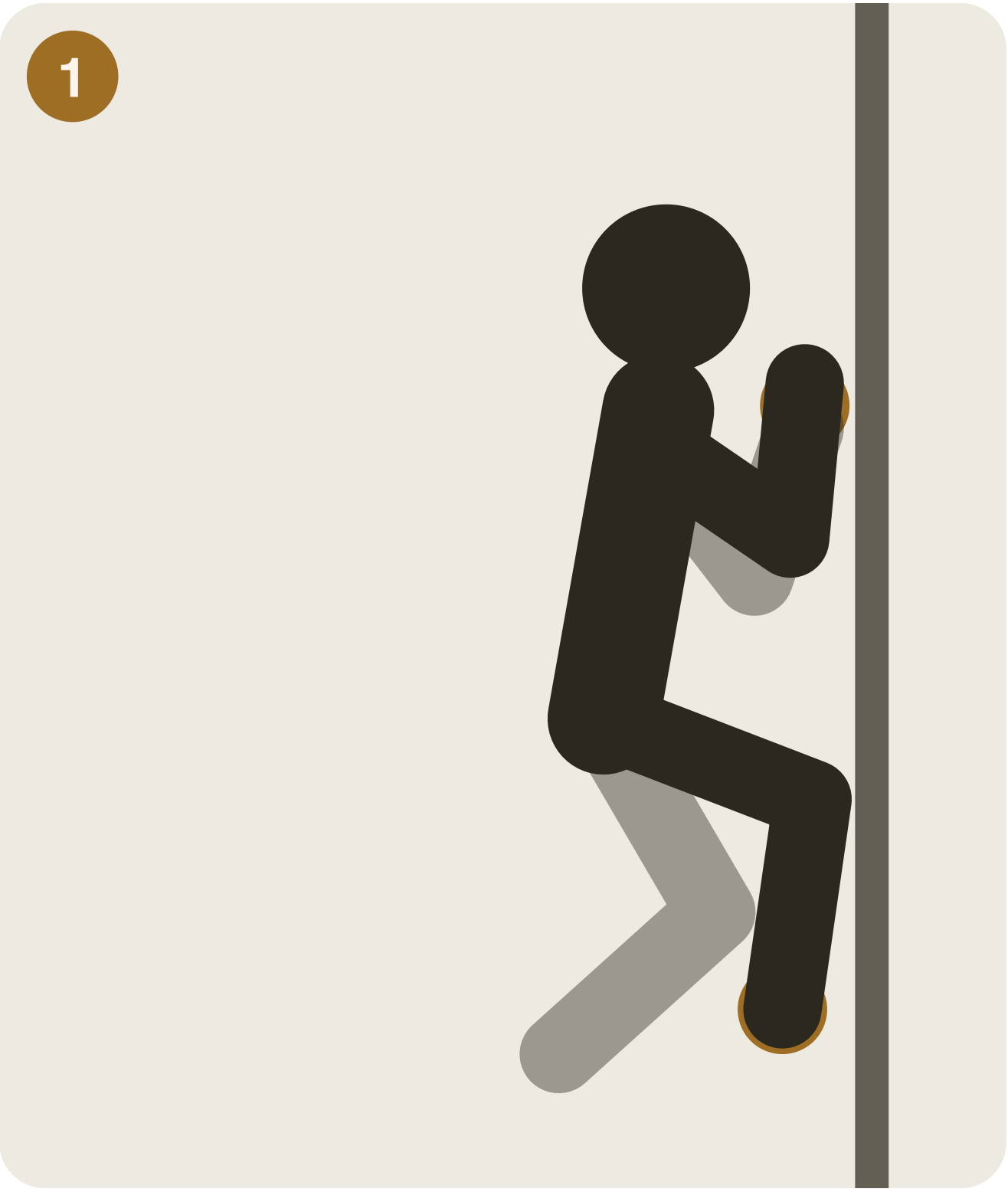


1. Keep one foot off the wall and balance over the other

One-leg climb

control · technique · **3 easy problems, alternate legs**

Keep one foot off the wall for the whole problem. Teaches balance and how to manage momentum and weight over a single foot.



1. Keep one foot off the wall and balance over the other

No-hands slab

footwork · technique · **3-5 min on easy slab**

Climb easy slab without using your hands. Hips over feet, smearing and edging only.

Take-away

footwork · play · **1 easy problem, 5-6 rounds**

Pick an easy problem with plenty of feet and remove one foothold each time you pass it. Keep going until it is hard but still possible.

Drop-knee laps

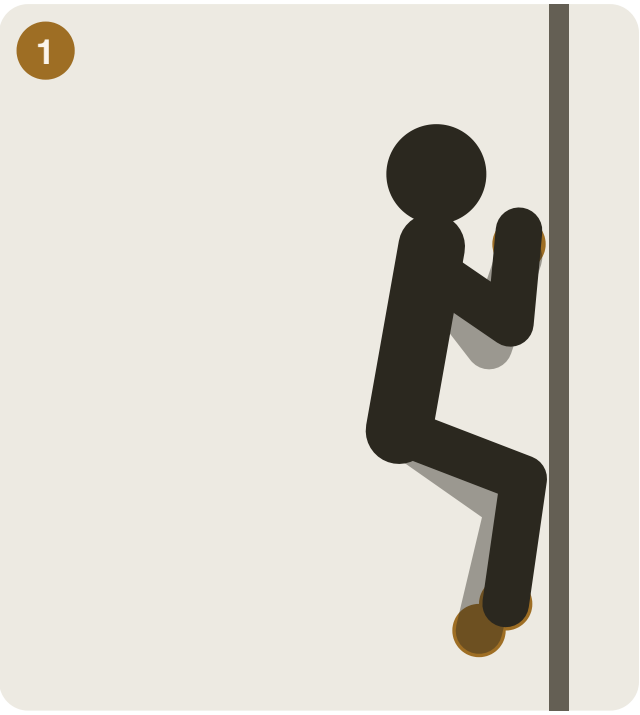
technique · **3 problems**

On each problem use as many drop-knees as you can: toe on a hip-height foothold, knee rolled in and pointing down, hips turned to the wall.

Flagging laps

technique · warmup · **3 problems**

On each problem use as many flags as you can, inside and outside, to counter the swing and keep your balance on small feet.



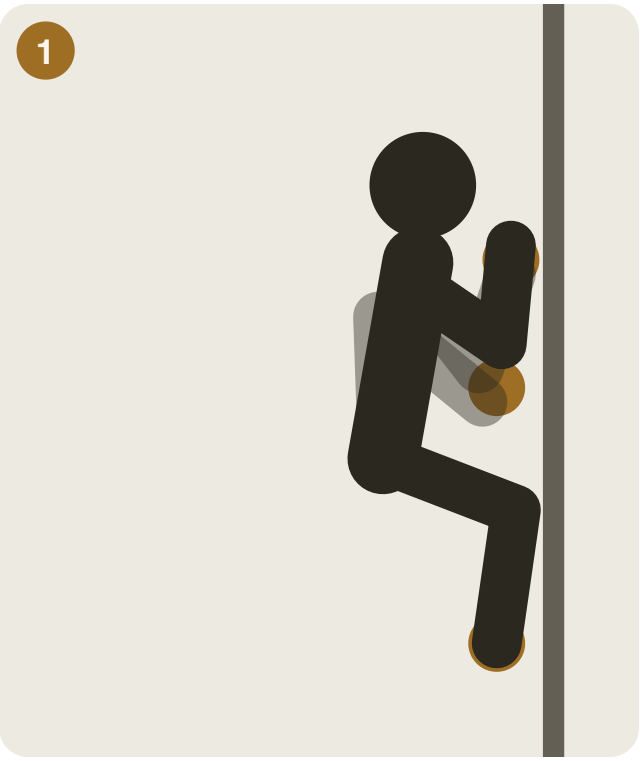


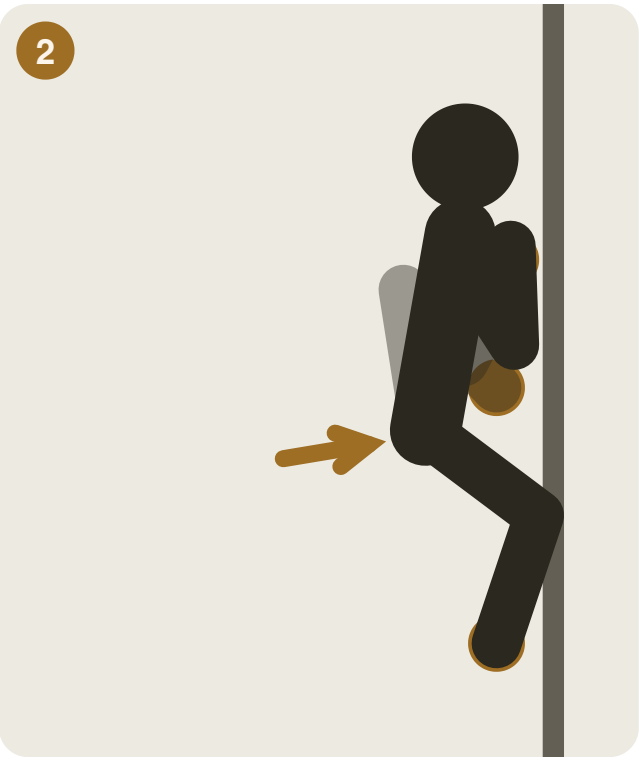
1. Both feet on holds, weight balanced
2. Lift one foot and swing the leg out to counterbalance

Hook laps

technique · **3 problems**

Use as many heel hooks and toe hooks as the problem allows. Heel hooks pull the hips in and give reach; toe hooks train the core.





1. Hook the heel over a hold at about hip height
2. Pull with the hamstring so the hips come in toward the wall

Backstep traverse

technique · footwork · **2-3 laps**

Traverse using backsteps on the outside edge of the shoe so the hip turns into the wall. Straighten the arms and rest in the turned position.

Deadpoint practice

technique · **5-6 moves, just beyond static**

Pick moves slightly too far to reach statically. Pull and let the hips drive, and take the hold at the very top of the motion where it weighs least.

Same problem three ways

technique · control · **1 problem, 3 versions**

Climb the same easy problem three times, each time starting each move differently: hips first, feet first, then hands first.

Downclimb

control · footwork · **3 easy problems**

Climb down what you climb up, ideally with the same quiet feet. Exposes weak footwork because you cannot see the holds as easily.

Add-on (play)

play · warmup · **10 min with a partner**

Take turns: the first climber makes three moves, the next copies them and adds one, and so on until someone slips. Then start over.

Copy me (play)

play · warmup · **10 min with a partner**

One person sets a line of holds as they move and the other follows exactly the same holds and body positions. Swap after each line.

Book drill list

Titles only, from your two books. The content is in the books.

Training for Climbing

Technique

- Twist-Lock & Backstep
- Flagging (inside-edge flag-across / outside-edge flag-out)
- Drop-Knee
- Rock-Over
- High-Step Precision Drill
- Downclimbing Routes
- Small-Foot Elimination (Tracking and Elimination)
- First Touch
- Speed Training

Fingers

- Minimum-Edge Hangs
- HIT System (max-strength hangs)

Power-Endurance

- Bouldering 4x4s
- System Wall Repeaters

Power

- Campus Laddering (feet-on)
- Big-Move Boulder Problems

Climb to Fitness

Technique

- Precision Feet (footwork drill)
- Foot Stab (footwork drill)
- Blinking (footwork drill)
- Jibs Only (footwork drill)
- Downclimbing (footwork drill)
- Glue Feet (footwork drill)
- Observe (footwork drill)
- Create a Crux
- MoonBoard
- Bookends
- Flash Sessions

- Limit Bouldering
- Traverse Eliminates
- Climb with Grace on the System Board

Endurance

- Climb Forever Arc Sets
- Leapfrog
- Pyramids
- Roped Intervals
- Volume for Points
- Laps
- 3x10 Intervals
- Up-Downs
- Treadwall Training

Strength

- Bouldering Intervals
- World Cup Simulator
- Tales of Power
- 4x4s
- Circuits
- Lockoffs
- Peter Pans
- Project, Push-Up, Pull-Up
- Upper Body Tabata
- Strong Circuits
- Home Improvement
- Freaky Fit

Fingers

- Hangboarding 101
- Hangboard Repeaters
- Fingerboard Moving Hangs
- Hangboard Ladders
- Digit Dialing
- 6-Second Death Drop
- Perfect Pull-Ups

Power

- Make Big Moves on the Campus Board
- Ladders on the Bachar Ladder

Core

- Complete Core
- Suspended Circuits

Legs

- Do the Legwork

Injury Prevention

- Targeted Opposition
- Shoulder Routine
- Wrist Routine
- Protect Your Elbows and Shoulders

Mobility

- Essential Yoga Poses

- Shoulder and Hip Strengthening

Training structure

Training structure

How the app organizes training, as it is built today.

Cycle phases

Skill & Stamina

High-volume, mostly submaximal climbing to build technique, movement skill, and aerobic capacity. Keep most climbing well below max difficulty — avoid grinding on near-limit problems this phase.

- **10-20 min** Warmup + mobility
- **60-120+ min** Varied submaximal climbing — high vertical footage, only light-moderate pump
- Light strength/core
- Cooldown

Max Strength & Power

Lower-volume, high-intensity: near-limit bouldering and short, powerful efforts.

- **15-25 min** Warmup + mobility
- **30-60 min** Near-limit / hypergravity bouldering
- **20-30 min** Finger-strength work (hangboard)
- **10-20 min** Pull-power work
- **15-25 min** Core
- **10-40 min** Antagonist/stabilizer + posterior chain (fine as a separate day)
- Cooldown

Power-Endurance

Moderate-high intensity with short rest, building the ability to climb pumped without falling apart.

- **20-30 min** Progressive warmup
- **30-60 min** Interval-style climbing (e.g. 4x4s or similar)
- **15-20 min** Finger strength-endurance
- **10-20 min** Pull-muscle endurance
- **15-25 min** Core
- **20-40 min** Antagonist/posterior chain (fine as a separate day)
- Cooldown

Taper

Sharp drop in volume so the previous weeks' adaptations show up. Short sessions (20-40 min), one or two brief high-intensity touches early in the week, full rest days by the end. No new fatigue.

- Climbing + a little finger maintenance (a couple easy hangs, not a hangboard session) — early in the week
- Strength, antagonist, core — skippable this week, not just reduced

Weekly rhythm (reference, not enforced)

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Normal week	Rest	Climb	Exercise	Climb	Rest	Climb	Climb
Taper week	Climb	Rest	Climb	Rest	Rest	Rest	Rest

Weekly goals (minutes, adjustable in Settings)

Area	Normal week	Taper week

climb	150	50
fingers	40	20
strength	40	10
antag	50	10
core	40	10
flexibility	30	15
mobility	30	15
cardio	40	10

Warmup skeleton

Small to big, the same every session, only the exercises inside it rotate:

1. **Blood flow** (cardio): joint circles always, plus one rotating item.
2. **Prehab** (antagonist): 3 to 4 light exercises at 1x5 to 1x10, from body regions not yet covered this week.
3. **Movement pattern** (mobility): one coordinated compound movement, e.g. world's greatest stretch.
4. **Finger activation** (fingers): last, only when the session includes climbing or fingers.

One play item is included somewhere in the warmup, and some prehab is saved for the cooldown.

Climbing session model

A climbing session is built from these components, in this order:

1. **Warmup**: blood flow, prehab, movement pattern, then finger activation last
2. **Technique drills**, carried inside the easy climbing
3. **Main climbing**: max effort in Max Strength & Power, volume in Skill & Stamina, intervals in Power-Endurance
4. **Fingers, after climbing**: heavy hangs only on a heavy-fingers day, otherwise a short finger-health circuit
5. **Strength, antagonist and core work**
6. **Cooldown** with hip mobility

What stays at each length

Cuts come from the bottom of the list. The warmup (with finger activation), the main climbing and the cooldown are never cut.

Minutes	Kept
30	warmup, main climbing, cooldown
45	+ technique drills inside the easy climbing
60	+ one catch-up item (fingers or strength, whichever is missed this week)
90	+ a second catch-up item

Heavy-fingers day

No limit or max-effort climbing. Warmup, technique-only climbing at submaximal effort, then heavy finger training, then cooldown. In the Max Strength & Power phase there is at least one of these per week; the app suggests it until one is logged.

Weekly rules

- You set the least number of climbing sessions per week (default 2).
- Missed components this week (technique, max effort, fingers, strength, antagonist/prehab, mobility) are added to the next session within its time budget, at most two extras, in priority order.
- If the log suggests this is the only session of the week (nothing logged yet and few days left, or recent weeks have had one climb), nothing is stacked on: climbing and health only. You can override this on the Ask screen.
- If you are behind on the weekly minimum with few days left, climbing is favoured over exercise-only sessions.

Profile (four areas)

- **Strength**: fingers, pulling, power, endurance
- **Mobility**: range of motion and tension in hips and shoulders
- **Coordination**: footwork, precision, balance and timing
- **Awareness**: attention, nerve, reading the sequence, breathing

Each check-in is six comparisons (one per pair of areas): you pick which statement holds you back more. Example statements:

Strength

- My fingers or forearms give out before I run out of ideas.
- I can see the move but I can't pull or hold it.
- I run out of power on the hardest moves.
- I pump out on climbs that should feel easy.

Mobility

- I can't get my hips close to the wall or my foot high enough.
- Stiff hips or shoulders stop me getting into the position I want.
- I avoid moves that need a big stretch or a high step.
- The same spots feel tight after a session.

Coordination

- My feet are sloppy on small holds.
- I lose my balance mid-move and swing off.
- I mistime dynamic moves.
- I place a foot, then have to readjust it.

Awareness

- I tense up or hesitate at the crux.
- I lose the sequence or miss holds I could use.
- I climb on autopilot without noticing what my body is doing.
- I hold my breath or grip harder when it gets tough.

Benchmarks

Run in taper weeks or from Settings.

Test	Area	Unit	How
Pull-ups	strength	reps	Strict reps from a dead hang, chin over the bar, no kipping. Stop when form slips.
Dead hang	strength	sec	Hang from a bar with an active shoulder, as long as you can hold it well.
Deep squat hold	mobility	sec	Heels flat, chest up, as low as you can go. Seconds you can stay comfortable, up to 120.
Single-leg balance, eyes closed	coordination	sec	Weaker side, hands on hips, standing on a firm floor. Stop at a hop, touch-down or 60 sec.
Push-ups	antagonist	reps	Strict reps, chest close to the floor, body in one line.
Side plank, weaker side	antagonist	sec	On a forearm, hips lifted in a straight line. Stop when the hips drop.
Wall angels	antagonist	reps	Back and forearms against a wall, slide the arms up and down. Count reps with contact held.

What each logged breakdown counts toward

Breakdown	Area
Grip/forearms gave out	strength
Got pumped	strength

Shoulders gave out	strength
Core gave out	strength
Legs gave out	strength
Ran out of energy	strength
Had to cut it short	strength
Couldn't reach the hold	mobility
Too stiff for the move	mobility
Too tight to get into position	mobility
Footwork broke down	coordination
Feet cut loose	coordination
Lost form	coordination
Lost the sequence	awareness
Couldn't commit to the move	awareness
Mental — backed off	awareness
Mental — lost focus	awareness

Routines in the exercise library

- **Core Circuit**: 13 exercises
- **Leg Day**: 10 exercises
- **Upper Tabata**: 4 exercises
- **TRX — Core**: 3 exercises
- **TRX — Shoulder**: 4 exercises
- **Full Efficient Workout**: 20 exercises
- **Yoga Poses**: 14 exercises
- **Static Stretch**: 18 exercises
- **Foam Rolling**: 7 exercises
- **Lacrosse Ball Release**: 5 exercises
- **Functional Movement**: 9 exercises
- **Body Prep**: 9 exercises
- **Cardio Circuit**: 7 exercises
- **Fingers**: 9 exercises
- **Prehab**: 23 exercises
- **General/Other**: 14 exercises